

power players like JSW energy, Jaiprakash Ventures, NLC India Limited, and Torrent Power also improved their rankings based on the average m-cap.

Sharad Mahendra, Joint MD & CEO of JSW Energy, says the company's focus remains on supporting India in its ambitious journey towards a net-zero carbon future by providing solutions for round-the-clock green energy through solar, wind & energy storage mix.

"With backward integration, transformative technologies, innovative offerings, and ongoing projects in solar, wind and energy storage, we are on track to achieve a 10 GW capacity by 2025 and 20 GW significantly earlier than 2030. Our vision is to shape a greener future while delivering strong economic value for our stakeholders," Mahendra tells *BT*.

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Credit rating agency ICRA says investments over ₹3 lakh crore are needed every year in renewable energy to take India's installed green capacity to 440 GW by 2030.

Girish Kumar Kadam, Group Head Corporate Sector Ratings at ICRA Ltd, says India has made significant progress in renewable energy capacity addition with a strong policy focus, but factors such as energy storage, grid integration, and fully-integrated renewable energy equipment manufacturing pose challenges.

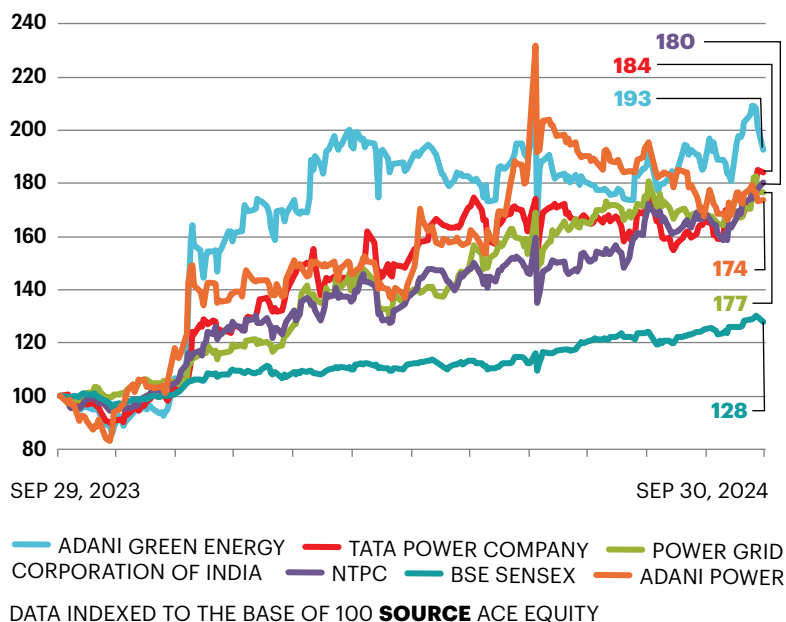
"The evolving landscape presents both risks and significant investment opportunities, especially as the demand for cleaner energy sources intensifies. The sector's growth potential is immense, provided the government addresses these pressing issues expeditiously," Kadam says.

The Indian Energy Exchange (IEX) has been hit in terms of m-cap. The average market capitalisa-

HOW STOCKS FARED

➤ Power stocks underperformed BSE Sensex during the study period

➤ Adani Green Energy, Tata Power & NTPC gained over 80%



tion of the largest power exchange platform, which handles more than 90% of power deals, was ₹14,404 crore in FY23. In FY24, it fell to ₹12,506 crore. This fall is attributable to the government's decision to implement market coupling in power exchanges.

Market coupling is a process that matches bids from all the power exchanges to discover the uniform market clearing price.

Power demand is now driven by new areas such as EVs, data centres, and increased electrification across industries. Ensuring non-intermittent power supply through investment in storage capacity remains a key focus area for companies.

Arun Kailasan, Analyst, Fundamental Research at financial services firm Geojit, says battery storage is undergoing a transition and even a good amount of capex allo-

cation could turn out to be meaningless with evolving technology. "Batteries are getting more push from recent government tenders and pump storage is also gaining attention. Only time will tell how the storage sector will play out, and we keep a very neutral stand on it," says Kailasan.

Among other challenges, Kailasan believes many power projects are getting delayed not because of execution but because of improper transmission infrastructure and land-related issues.

As the country's power demand rises in tandem with economic growth, it will be important to watch how companies scale up their capacities and come up with innovative solutions to shift to a greener future. *BT*

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